



Disability and Diabetes Prevention

APRIL 8, 2025

 For Everyone

ABOUT

- About 1 in 6 people with disabilities (16.2%) in the United States in 2020 had been diagnosed with diabetes.
- There are different ways that people with disabilities can get support to test for, diagnose, or manage type 2 diabetes.
- CDC supports several programs to prevent type 2 diabetes.

Type 2 diabetes and people with disabilities

About 1 in 6 people with disabilities (16.2%) in the United States in 2020 had been diagnosed with diabetes, compared to 1 in 14 people without disabilities (7.5%). Differences are also observed across various states, races/ethnicities, and age groups. For example, diabetes is more common among people with disabilities who live in Mississippi (about 1 in 5 or 18.8%) compared to those who live in South Dakota (about 1 in 10 or 10.1%).[\[1\]](#)



It is important for people with disabilities to know their diabetes status to help them make the best decisions for their health. If you have a disability, learn what you can do to prevent or manage type 2 diabetes.

You are at risk for developing type 2 diabetes if you:

- Have [prediabetes](#).
- Are overweight.

- Are 45 years or older.
- Have a parent or sibling with type 2 diabetes.
- Are physically active less than 3 times per week.
- Have ever had diabetes while pregnant (gestational diabetes) or given birth to a baby who weighed more than 9 pounds.
- Are African American, Hispanic/Latino American, American Indian, or Alaska Native (some Pacific Islanders and Asian Americans are also at higher risk).

Visit the [Disability and Health Data System](#) to learn more about diabetes among people with disabilities in your state and nationwide.

November is Diabetes Awareness Month

Join the conversation on social media about preventing and managing diabetes among people with disabilities by searching #DisabilityandDiabetes



What people with disabilities can do

There are different ways that people with disabilities can get support to test for, diagnose, or manage type 2 diabetes.

- Talk to a healthcare provider about taking a [simple blood test](#). This blood test can tell you if you have diabetes, or if you are at risk for type 2 diabetes.
- If diagnosed with [prediabetes](#), consider joining the [National Diabetes Prevention Program](#) to help you make lifestyle changes to prevent or delay Type 2 diabetes.
- Remember to [eat well](#), [get active](#), and [maintain a healthy weight](#) to manage your blood sugar.
- Talk to a healthcare provider about ways to manage your blood sugar to keep you from having other [serious health problems](#).
- Find other [lifestyle change programs](#) in your state that can help you prevent or delay type 2 diabetes, or better [manage your diabetes](#).
- Use a list to stay on [schedule](#) with self-checks, exams, and appointments throughout the year to manage your diabetes and prevent or delay health problems.

How CDC supports people with disabilities and diabetes

Projects

CDC supported a project at the University of South Carolina that resulted in a publication, [Disparities in diabetes management among Medicaid recipients with intellectual and developmental disabilities \(IDD\): Evidence from five U.S. states](#)¹. The goal of the project was to better understand the quality of diabetes care received by adults with IDD. The project provided information about the diabetes care needs among people with IDD insured by Medicaid in Iowa, Massachusetts, New York, Oregon, and South Carolina. It also served as the first study that looked at the quality of care for diabetes in the Medicaid population with IDD across multiple states.

Public health programs

Prevent T2 for All

CDC funds the [National Centers on Disability](#), including Special Olympics and the National Center on Health, Physical Activity, and Disability (NCHPAD), which work to reduce the health differences between people with and without disabilities through inclusive health activities. NCHPAD adapted CDC's [PreventT2](#) curriculum to create *Prevent T2 for All*. The aim of *Prevent T2 for All* is to improve access to lifestyle change programs for people with disabilities. Over a 12-month period, adults who have been diagnosed with prediabetes learn how to achieve modest weight loss, increase physical activity, and make other lifestyle changes to prevent or delay type 2 diabetes. NCHPAD also provides training on creating and sustaining an inclusive Diabetes Prevention Program and Disease Self-Management Education and Support program to its partners.

Several of CDC's funded [State Disability and Health Programs](#), such as Florida, Minnesota, New York, and Montana, have also partnered with NCHPAD to offer trainings on Prevent T2 for All. Other funded states, like Michigan and Kentucky, have developed resources about [diabetes](#)² including [curriculum recommendations](#) ^{PDF}³ and handouts on [A1c readings](#)⁴ and [blood sugar tests](#)⁵ to make information accessible for people with disabilities.

Taking charge of your diabetes educational video

CDC funded the University of South Carolina to develop a video with self-advocates who have IDD and includes nine tips to help viewers manage their diabetes. A collaboration was formed across 10 State Disability and Health Programs (Arkansas, Iowa, Kansas, Massachusetts,

Michigan, Montana, New Hampshire, New York, Oregon, and South Carolina) to create the [Taking Charge of Your Diabetes](#) educational video.

More information

- [Disability and Health-related Conditions](#)
- [What is Diabetes?](#)
- [Flu and People with Diabetes](#)
- [Living with Diabetes: Prevent Complications](#)
- [Your Diabetes Care Schedule](#)

SOURCES AND PAGE INFO

CONTENT SOURCE:
[Disability and Health; National Center on Birth Defects and Developmental Disabilities](#)

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REFERENCES

1. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, National Center on Birth Defects and Developmental Disabilities, Division of Human Development and Disability. Disability and Health Data System (DHDS) [online]. Accessed November 23, 2022. URL: <https://dhds.cdc.gov>.

SOURCES

- [National Center on Birth Defects and Developmental Disabilities](#)
- [Centers for Disease Control and Prevention](#)
- Balogh RS, Lake JK, Lin E, et al. Disparities in diabetes prevalence and preventable hospitalizations in people with intellectual and developmental disability: a population-based study. *Diabet Med*. 2015; 32(2): 235-42. doi: 10.1111/dme.12573